AI Tool Tier List (Manus Got Cooked)

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 31, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/fiEISwCgz6k Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter speed-ranks 9 AI/productivity tools, crowning Claude Code, ChatGPT Codex, Jeremy AI, and GoHighLevel as S-tier while dunking on Manus as F-tier and calling out Descript as recently dethroned.

📑 Contents

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- 🏆 GoHighLevel — S Tier

🎯 MetaMuse — A Tier 0:00

- Rated **A tier** — one of the best tools he uses
  - Key differentiator: tight integration with Instagram
  - Use case: scanning all DMs to surface leads that may have slipped through the cracks

🔥 Fireflies — B Tier 0:00

- Rated **B tier** — solid but not exceptional
  - Category: AI note-taking app
  - Use case: recording all calls from the sales team
  - Critique: "pretty good, I just feel like it could be better" — no specific replacement mentioned

✂️ Descript — C Tier (Dethroned) 0:00

- Rated **C tier** — a notable demotion
  - Earlier in the same year he would have given it A tier

- Reason for demotion: replaced in his workflow by Claude Code

🤖 Claude Code — S Tier t=22s

- Rated **S tier** — one of his top tools overall
  - Primary use case highlighted: video editing ("this video is edited with Claude Code")
  - Described as capable of "all types" of tasks beyond just editing
  - Directly displaced Descript as his video editing tool

💻 ChatGPT Codex — S Tier t=22s

- Rated **S tier** — and he says he actually likes it **better than Claude Code**
  - Reason: does "way more things" with it
  - Main use cases: building tools and apps for himself, his team, and his clients

⚡ Groq Bot — A Tier t=45s

- Rated **A tier** — would be S tier with one caveat
  - The limiting factor: credit consumption is extremely high
  - Quip: "I feel like if you say the word Groq Bot too many times, you're going to use up all your credits"

💩 Manus — F Tier t=45s

- Rated **F tier** — the most negative rating in the video
  - Context: heavily hyped earlier in the year and the year prior
  - His take: "I always thought it was kind of booty" — never bought into the hype

> "I feel like people were hyping this up earlier this year and last year and I always thought it was kind of booty."

🧠 Jeremy AI — S Tier t=45s

- Rated **S tier** — with a disclosed bias (Jeremy is his best friend)
  - Target audience: marketers specifically
  - Use cases: marketing advice, ad strategy and optimization
  - Recommendation: "anytime you need any sort of marketing advice... you got to go with Jeremy AI"

📋 Notion — B Tier t=67s

- Rated **B tier** — good but not great in practice
  - Positive: generally solid tool

- Critique: "can get super clunky"
- Self-aware caveat: "that's probably a skill issue — my Notion is a mess"

🏆 GoHighLevel — S Tier t=67s

- Rated **S tier** — the final and emphatic top pick
  - Category: CRM (Customer Relationship Management)
  - Longevity: has been using it for **10 years**
  - Core use: runs his entire sales team and sales database through it
  - AI feature: built-in AI agents that autonomously book calls via DM, text message, and email
  - Strong endorsement: implies it's essential for anyone serious about business (transcript cuts off mid-sentence)